



# Tips & Tricks



## Configure VNC for a normal display

Here's a tip to configure VNC for a normal display:

```
vncserver -geometry 1024x768 --depth 16:1
vncserver -kill hostname:1
```

If there is just a shell available, go to `/root/.vnc` and edit the `xstartup` file.

The complete file is as shown below:

```
#!/bin/sh
#Uncomment the following two lines for a normal desktop:
unset SESSION_MANAGER
exec /etc/X11/xinit/xinitrc
[ -x /etc/vnc/xstartup ] && exec /etc/vnc/xstartup
[ -r $HOME/.Xresources ] && xrb $HOME/.Xresources
xsetroot -solid grey
vncconfig -iconic &
xterm -geometry 80x24+10+10 -ls -title "$VNCDESKTOP Desktop" &
twm &
```

That's it.

—Vipul Tailor, [tailorvipul@gmail.com](mailto:tailorvipul@gmail.com)



## Protecting GRUB, Linux and other OSs with different passwords

Generally, we protect GRUB with a password to prevent anyone from editing it. The technique shown below will simultaneously protect the GRUB, Linux and Windows OSs with different customised passwords.

Follow the steps given below to protect GRUB.

Step 1: From the console, open `/etc/grub.conf` or the `/boot/grub/menu.lst` (depending on your distro) in vi or any text editor.

```
vi /etc/grub.conf
```

Step 2: Open another console and issue the following command:

```
grub-md5-crypt
Password:
```

Type the password (say, grub).

Retype the password.

Copy the output in your clipboard. The above can also be done by issuing the following command:

```
#grub
```

This will take you to the GRUB prompt, where you type and press `Enter`:

```
grub>md5crypt
```

You will now be asked for your password; enter it and then copy the output to the clipboard.

Step 3: At Console 1, where you have the `grub.conf` open, paste the contents of your clipboard below the line `"splash image=.....xpm.gz"` in the following pattern:

```
password --md5 <encrypted form of password>
```

Save the file and exit.

Now, here's how to protect other OSs like the Linux OS.

Step 1: Same as the above.

Step 2: Same as the above (except that the password chosen here is 'linux').

Step 3: In this case, copy the encrypted form of the password and paste it below the line `"initrd .....img"` in the following pattern:

```
password --md5 <encrypted form of password>
```

Save the file and exit.

Follow the steps given below to protect the Windows OS.

Step 1: Same as above

Step 2: Same as above (except that the password chosen here is 'windows')

Step 3: In this case, copy the encrypted form of the password and paste it below the line `"title OTHER"` in the following pattern: